

DOC File

A Microsoft Word Document File. In the past, these files contained only document data, but with many newer versions of Microsoft Word, DOC files also include small programs called macros. Many virus authors use the macro programming language to associate macros with DOC files. This file type has the extension DOC.

EEPROM

Electrically Erasable and Programmable Read-Only Memory. A type of ROM whose contents are non-volatile, but modifiable through the application of appropriate chip reprogramming voltages.

EICAR

European Institute for Computer Antivirus Research. A group of academics, researchers, law enforcement specialists and other technologists united against writing and proliferation of malicious code such as computer viruses or trojan horses, and against computer crime, fraud and the misuse of computers or networks

E-mail Worm

A commonly used misnomer for mass mailing viruses

Emulator

A commonly used method for detecting polymorphic viruses is to simulate running part of a program's code in an emulator. The purpose is to see if the code decrypts known virus code. There are several essentially irresolvable issues with emulator design. For example, ensuring they don't run for 'too long' on each file thus slowing the scanner down, and making them complex enough to include sufficient aspects of the environment they simulate that anti-emulation and emulation detection techniques employed in some viruses do not reduce their usefulness.

Encrypted Virus

An early attempt at evading scan string driven virus detectors was self-encryption with a variable key.